

Week 2 of Conversations - May 18, 2025

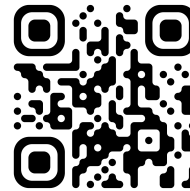
I. Welcome!

If you are a first-time guest or you are wanting to plug in more to weekly virtual prayer meetings, our Wednesday night small groups, serving, or membership—*Fill out our digital connect card to stay connected!*



II. Announcements

- Pentecost Sunday will be on June 8 at 6 pm with 10 Days of prayer leading up to it (May 28-June 6). Devotional guides are available to grab today! Register for Pentecost ATL by scanning this QR Code:**



III. Message: Starting the Conversation

Introduction: The Desperation of a Cry and the Invitation of a Conversation

- **Illustration:** Timothy Treadwell's desperate prayer in *Grizzly Man* — calling out to any god who might listen, yet experiencing no lasting transformation.
- **Transition:** Desperation can trigger a cry, but God invites us into more than a fleeting moment—He invites us into a continual, life-transforming conversation.

I. The Common Cry – Everyone Prays in Desperation

- **Illustration:** Treadwell's prayer as a reflection of instinctive, crisis-driven prayers.
- **Scripture:**
 - Jeremiah 33:3 – “Call to me and I will answer you and tell you great and unsearchable things you do not know.”
 - Romans 8:15-16 – We have received the Spirit of sonship, allowing us to cry, “Abba, Father.”
- **Application:** Prayer is more than a plea for help; it's an invitation to connection.

II. The Moment of Awakening – Recognizing God's Voice

- **Illustration:** Hazen's college years – God's voice breaking through in the midst of external success but internal emptiness.
- **Scripture:**

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- John 10:27 – “My sheep hear my voice; I know them, and they follow me.”
 - Isaiah 30:21 – “Your ears will hear a voice behind you, saying, ‘This is the way; walk in it.’”

- **Application:** God speaks in the mundane and the miraculous—are we listening?

III. The Shift in Perspective – From Monologue to Dialogue

- **Illustration:** Andrew Murray – prayer as a dialogue rather than a monologue.
- **Scripture:**
 - Proverbs 3:5-6 – “Trust in the Lord with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways submit to him, and he will make your paths straight.”
 - Revelation 5:8 – Prayers of the saints as incense before the throne of God.
- **Application:** Prayer is not about bending God’s will but aligning ours with His.

IV. The Invitation to Ongoing Conversation – Living as God’s Beloved

- **Illustration:** Jesus teaching us to call God “Abba” in the Lord’s Prayer.
- **Scripture:**
 - Romans 8:15-16 – “The Spirit himself testifies with our spirit that we are God’s children.”
 - Galatians 4:6-7 – “Because you are his sons, God sent the Spirit of his Son into our hearts, the Spirit who calls out, ‘Abba, Father.’”
- **Application:** Every moment can become a dialogue with God, not just a crisis call.

Conclusion: The Transformative Power of Prayer

- **Illustration:** Recap Treadwell’s prayer – the rain came, but the deeper transformation was missed.
- **Call to Action:** Move beyond crisis prayers to ongoing conversations with God.
 - **Reflective Listening:** Spend five minutes in silence, asking, “Lord, what do You want to say to me today?”
 - **Scripture Reflection:** Read John 10:27 and listen for God’s voice.
 - **Prayer Journal:** Write a prayer to God, then write what you sense He is saying in response.

Reminder: Connect this Week with Virtual Prayer! →

Mornings (Mon-Fri): 7:30-8:15 am

Afternoons (Wed, Fri): 12:15-1:00 pm

Evenings (Mon, Tues, Thurs): 8:15-9:00 pm

